

INTRODUCTION

Development of applications has never gotten as diverse as it is today. Looking back a few years, when people had to build software applications, it would primarily be used on computers and the frameworks were few. The operating systems themselves were restricted to Windows, Mac or Linux. Then with the rise of the internet came the Rich Internet Applications or RIAs which would run on the web or browsers just like desktop applications in many ways. But now with the rapid advancements in mobile technologies, the advent of the modern age smart phones, and their usage & availability picking up like wildfire, the demand for mobile applications is immense. Even statistically with a global figure of over 5 billion mobile users, it is clear that the smartphone market has massive potential for growth. There are a multitude of Operating systems like iOS, Android, Blackberry OS, Windows Phone 7 etc. and different versions of the same. The frameworks and platforms used for developing applications for these devices are also aplenty.

There is a big necessity for finding a single framework to build applications compatible across all devices and operating systems. Adobe has taken a very big step in this direction. With the release of Adobe Flash Builder 4.5 and Flex 4.5 with the Adobe Creative Suite 5.5 release, it is now offering unprecedented new capabilities for building mobile applications and content. These new additions apart from their older application for building software for desktops, now offer a new mobile development paradigm as well, letting you make use of one single tool and development framework for building applications that work across different platforms. What this means is that with one primary code base you can build applications for all major Android, Blackberry Tablet OS and iOS devices.